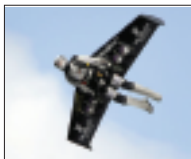


Rocketman

Yves Rossy became the first man to cross the English Channel using a single jet powered wing. Rossy is a Swiss who worked as an airplane pilot. He crossed the channel from Calais to Dover. He is nicknamed the Fusionman



Stop That Noise!

Usually earphones are designed to cancel external noise. These semicircular earphones called the iSound are designed by Seohyun Baek and are designed so that external noise is actually *let in!* This allows for relatively safe riding or navigation



Escape

EA MAKES MORE FRIENDS

Spore Ships With DRM And Trouble

EA has managed to earn a fair deal of hatred from gamers all over the world for trying to take over every game studio all over the globe. The latest bit of hatred comes from their latest and highly anticipated game title — *Spore*. *Spore* is a game all about freedom and evolution, but the installation of *Spore* forcibly adds a DRM system on to gamers' computers. It appears EA might need to learn a few lessons on freedom themselves.

EA is also being attacked by a lawsuit. Consumers are fuming over the DRM software not uninstalling when you remove the game, and also setting a limit on the number of installs allowed with a single copy of the game. Initially a limit of three installs was allowed, but that was later pushed to five.

To make matters worse, the DRM has been easily disabled by crackers and distributed over the Internet, thus allowing users who illegally download the game to have a DRM-free installation, while paid users suffer. A look at the Amazon's customer feedback page for *Spore* shows only a fraction of the users rating the game above one on five — all this after a seven year long development period. Despite all the controversy surrounding the game, the launch went off smoothly and has been gaining popularity very fast. EA's other big title *Crysis Warhead* just came out and there have been fears of the game being sold with DRM built into it. It appears the single player

game has the DRM, but the multiplayer component



which comes on a separate disc doesn't.

EA isn't out only to trouble gamers — it's also been causing a fair deal of trouble to residents of North London. Motorists found a long queue of traffic lined up leading to a petrol station. The reason is EA's latest publicity stunt for their upcoming title — *Mercenaries 2*. EA was providing 20 pounds of free petrol to motorists and a total of some 20,000 pounds worth of fuel was purchased. The game *Mercenaries 2* is set in Venezuela and fuel is used as a currency.

NOW AVAILABLE

Duke Nukem Just Got More Affordable!

That's right! Just when all the game makers were dropping prices to make it more appealing to users and especially for Indian users, 3D Realms has taken, what many feel is a mysterious step. *Duke Nukem 3D*, a game that came out in 1996 was given a price drop just a few days back to \$10. It's a shock as pretty much all of humanity might have

Whatever Happened To... Commodore?

Commodore international was a company started in America by a Polish national, Jack Tramiel after surviving the largest Nazi concentration camp. From the mid-fifties to the mid-seventies, the company manufactured and sold programmable scientific calculators and early PCs like the Commodore PET and the 8-bit Commodore VIC-20. These machines were revolutionary in their time, but too costly for everyday computing and home use.

In 1982, the company released the Commodore 64. The C64 did to computers what the Model T ford did to automobiles. Beating the rivals Atari 400/800 and the Apple II, the C64 went on to sell 30 million units, making it the most sold computer model in history. The C64 was responsible for bringing about the cultural revolution that put a computer in every home and computation power in everyone's hands. For many people all over the world, the C64 was the first computer. The older readers may recall playing Boulderdash, Turrican or Pit Stop on one of these machines.

The Commodore 128 did not make as much as an impression as its predecessor, and from there on, the company went into decline. A slight revival was witnessed with the company buying out Amiga, but in the early nineties, apple and IBM caught on. In 1994, the company declared bankruptcy, they were surviving so far on marginal sales of games.

In 2007 however, the company came back into action, selling high end gaming rigs, with customizable outer casings from Amsterdam.



downloaded and played the game for "free" already.

The game is also available to Xbox Live users for the same price. Those who already played the game back in the 90's are still waiting for the next installation of *Duke Nukem: Forever* which has been in development and promotional phase since 1997. Vaporware anyone?

FACEBOOK BANS WEIRD NAMES

Also Blocks Bugmenot.com!

In this age of heightning security risks in every form, in everything we do online, Facebook has decided to come down on users with awkward names. Facebook has gone on a spree to ban users who do not use their usual names. Facebook can apparently

do this without any issues unless you show them your identification proof. Facebook has been even more paranoid now and has been banning users for posting too much, too often and having too many contacts on their contact list. Some noted writers and artists have fallen prey to this practice and they aren't pleased. Hiroda Yoda an author from Japan, Rowena Gay from New Zealand and a designer by the name of Beta Yee were some of the people to get banned. Facebook says that it wants people to give authentic information about themselves online.

Facebook also started blocking any content related to Bugmenot.com — a site dedicated to giving users anonymous user IDs and passwords. A day after they blocked it, annoyed readers on Facebook struck back and Facebook quickly unblocked the content soon after.

Facebook was also said to block content to do with Wadja.com, another social networking site.

Thompson Can't Practise Law Anymore

Jack Thompson has a history and has created an image for himself for speaking out and protesting against violent and obscene games. His attacks against Take-Two and Rockstar Entertainment for their games such as *Bully* and *Grand Theft Auto* have earned him the reputation. Recently, Jack Thompson was disbarred by a Florida court after he was found guilty of 27 of the 31 charges against him in the cases related to the game *Bully*. The offenses he was found guilty for were acts such as making false accusations without any proof. A fine of around \$43,500 (20 Lakh) was also levied on him. He has now been given a month to clear all ongoing cases.

Jack Thompson hasn't fully given up protesting this barring order, it is still a huge blow for him, and a victory for game developers. Thompson is now likely to need a lawyer to fight the disbarment order. Although he won't be able to practice law anymore, don't expect to

People Who Changed Computing

Bram Cohen

Bram Cohen is the brains behind the widely used BitTorrent protocol, as well as the torrent client by the same name. He is a



Bram Cohen

computer programmer, and a math enthusiast with hobbies like origami and juggling.

Bram Cohen was born in 1975 and grew up in New York. He learnt the BASIC programming language when he was just five. Cohen went on to join the Buffalo university, but dropped out to participate in the dot com boom. He worked through a series of dot com companies, ending up at MojoNation, which was a service that distributed encrypted files from several machines. Cohen had the idea of using this system for file sharing. Cohen designed the BitTorrent protocol that allowed simultaneous downloads from many sharers at once, thus substantially increasing the speed at which data got distributed. The protocol was presented in 2002 at CodeCon.

The concept spread like wildfire, and soon several independent clients showed up to use the protocol.